

ShopSphere Operations

Enterprise Customer Support Knowledge Base (Vol 4)

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KB-016: Order Tracking and Shipment Visibility Workflow

Document Owner: Logistics Operations | **Applicability:** Tier 1 & Tier 2 Support Agents | **Related Systems:** Order Management System (OMS), Carrier API Gateway

1. Overview and Tracking Sync

This document establishes the standard operating procedures for resolving customer inquiries related to order tracking, shipment visibility, and mid-transit address corrections. ShopSphere utilizes a unified Carrier API Gateway that aggregates tracking data from multiple logistics partners into the OMS. Tracking updates typically sync every 4 hours. Customer Service Representatives (CSRs) must educate customers on this sync delay before escalating visibility issues.

2. Handling Shipment Scan Failures

A "shipment scan failure" occurs when a package is physically handed over to a courier partner, but the initial origin scan is not registered in the API.

- **0-48 Hours Post-Dispatch:** If a customer reports a tracking number showing "Label Created - Pending Scan" within 48 hours of dispatch, CSRs must advise the customer that the package is in transit and awaiting hub processing. No escalation is permitted.

- **48+ Hours Post-Dispatch:** If the tracking remains stalled after 48 business hours, the CSR must initiate a Tier 2 Logistics Escalation Workflow to query the warehouse outbound manifest. If the manifest confirms dispatch, the ticket transitions to the Lost Package Investigation Procedure (KB-017).

3. Partial Delivery Handling

ShopSphere frequently utilizes split shipments to optimize fulfillment from multiple regional warehouses. If a customer reports receiving only part of their order, the CSR must check the OMS "Fulfillment Nodes" tab.

- If the missing item is on a separate active tracking number, the CSR will provide the secondary tracking details.
- If the OMS indicates a single tracking number for all items, but the customer experienced a partial delivery, the CSR must immediately open a Pilferage/Shortage ticket, bypassing standard delay workflows.

4. Address Correction Procedures

Address corrections are highly time-sensitive.

- **Pre-Shipment (Status: Processing):** CSRs can perform a direct address correction in the OMS. This action automatically updates the Warehouse Management System (WMS) without penalty.
- **Post-Shipment (Status: Shipped/In Transit):** Once a package is in the carrier's possession, address corrections require a formal "Delivery Intercept" request via the Carrier API. This incurs a \$12 intercept fee. CSRs must obtain customer consent for this fee. Intercepts are not guaranteed. If an intercept fails, the package will follow standard courier partner failure handling (KB-019) and typically return to the sender.

KB-017: Lost Package Investigation Procedure

Document Owner: Risk & Logistics | **Applicability:** Tier 2 Support, Claims Adjusters | **Related Systems:** OMS, Courier Claims Portal

1. Definition of a Lost Package

A shipment is officially classified as "Lost in Transit" only when it meets specific criteria, distinct from standard delivery delays (KB-018). A package is deemed lost if:

- There have been continuous shipment scan failures for 7 consecutive calendar days (domestic) or 15 days (international).
- The courier explicitly flags the tracking status as "Lost," "Destroyed," or "Unrecoverable."
- A delivery scan is recorded, but the customer denies receipt, and 72 hours have passed since the delivery timestamp (Porch Piracy/Misdelivery).

2. Logistics Escalation Workflows (The Tracer Process)

Once a package qualifies as potentially lost, the CSR must launch a "Tracer Investigation." This involves submitting an electronic query through the Courier Claims Portal requiring the local delivery depot to perform a physical sweep of their facility and interview the final-mile driver.

- Standard tracer investigations take up to 5 business days.
- Customers must be informed of this timeline via strict customer communication protocols:
"ShopSphere has initiated a formal depot sweep with our logistics partner. We must allow them 5 business days to locate the parcel before we can issue a replacement or refund."

3. Resolution and Refund Eligibility

If the tracer confirms the package is lost, or if the 5-day SLA expires without a carrier response, the CSR is authorized to resolve the ticket. The customer is entitled to their choice of a full 100% refund to the original payment method or a free expedited replacement order.

4. Premium Customer Shipping Exceptions

ShopSphere Premium members are exempt from the standard 5-day tracer waiting period. If a Premium member reports a lost package and 7 days of shipment scan failures are verified, the CSR must immediately issue a replacement or refund. The back-end tracer investigation will still be conducted by the Claims Adjusters for corporate recovery purposes, but it must not delay the Premium customer's resolution.

KB-018: Late Delivery Escalation Policy

Document Owner: Customer Success Operations | **Applicability:** All Support Staff | **Related Systems:** CRM Concession Engine

1. Policy Overview

Delivery delays impact customer trust. This document outlines how ShopSphere compensates customers for missed delivery windows, distinguishing between minor delays and severe service failures. A package is only considered "late" if the current date exceeds the final day of the Estimated Delivery Date (EDD) window provided at checkout.

2. Evaluating Delivery Delays and Scan Activity

Before applying compensation, CSRs must review the tracking history.

- If the delay is due to a customer-requested address correction or a missed delivery attempt (customer unavailable), the order is **ineligible** for any delay compensation.
- If the delay is due to weather, natural disasters, or declared national emergencies, it falls under Force Majeure. Refunds are restricted, but minor appeasements can be offered.
- If the package exhibits prolonged shipment scan failures, verify if it qualifies for the Lost Package Investigation Procedure (KB-017) before applying standard delay protocols.

3. Refund Eligibility for Delays (Compensation Matrix)

Compensation is strictly tiered via the CRM Concession Engine based on the severity of the delay:

- **Tier 1 (1-3 Days Late):** Apology script applied. CSR is authorized to issue a \$10 ShopSphere Store Credit if the customer explicitly expresses dissatisfaction.
- **Tier 2 (4-7 Days Late):** The customer is entitled to a full refund of any expedited shipping fees paid at checkout. If standard free shipping was utilized, a 15% partial refund of the order subtotal (capped at \$40) is issued to the original payment method.
- **Tier 3 (8+ Days Late):** Escalate to lost package protocols. Customer receives a full refund or replacement while retaining the original item if it eventually arrives.

4. Premium Customer Exceptions

ShopSphere Premium members are guaranteed a strict 2-Day Delivery Service Level Agreement (SLA). If a Premium order is late by a single calendar day, the CRM Concession

Engine automatically triggers a proactive email containing a \$20 Store Credit. If the customer calls in, CSRs must acknowledge the systemic failure, ensure the automated credit was applied, and offer to upgrade the priority of any future replacements.

KB-019: Courier Partner Failure Handling

Document Owner: Carrier Relations & Logistics | **Applicability:** Tier 2 Support, Logistics Managers |
Related Systems: OMS, Mass Communications Tool

1. Systemic and Regional Courier Failures

While individual delivery delays are handled under KB-018, this document addresses systemic courier partner failures. These occur when a carrier experiences a massive hub outage, localized labor strikes, cyberattacks, or catastrophic sorting equipment failures that impact hundreds or thousands of ShopSphere shipments simultaneously.

2. Logistics Escalation and Rerouting

When the Carrier Relations team declares a "Courier Failure Event," normal service SLAs are suspended. Logistics Managers will activate bulk rerouting protocols for any pending orders, shifting volume to alternative carriers (e.g., from FedEx to UPS) at ShopSphere's expense.

For packages already trapped in the affected carrier's network, standard address correction procedures and delivery intercepts are completely disabled to prevent data collisions in the failing carrier's APIs.

3. Customer Communication Protocols

In the event of a mass courier failure, proactive communication is mandatory. Tier 2 agents will utilize the Mass Communications Tool to deploy a standardized email to all affected OMS profiles.

Approved Messaging: *"We have been notified that our logistics partner is experiencing severe regional disruptions impacting your delivery route. Your package is secure, but delivery will be delayed. We are actively monitoring the situation and will provide updates as the carrier's network recovers."*

CSRs must never blame the carrier in an unprofessional manner or speculate on recovery timelines beyond official statements.

4. Impact on Partial Deliveries

Courier failures often exacerbate partial delivery issues. A customer may receive Box 1 of 2 via a regional carrier, while Box 2 becomes trapped in a failing national hub. In these scenarios, CSRs must proactively generate an internal replacement order for the trapped items, shipping them via a secondary carrier, to ensure the customer receives their complete order without waiting for the courier outage to resolve.

KB-020: International Shipping and Customs Support

Document Owner: Global Trade Operations | **Applicability:** International Support Desk | **Related Systems:** Global Border API, OMS

1. Scope of International Support

International shipping introduces complex variables, including multi-carrier handoffs, sovereign border controls, and taxation. ShopSphere ships to over 50 countries primarily using Delivered Duty Paid (DDP) terms, meaning all customs duties and taxes are calculated and collected at checkout. This dramatically reduces customer friction upon delivery.

2. Customs Clearance Issues

The most common cause of international delivery delays is customs holds. A package may be flagged for random inspection or held due to vague commercial invoice descriptions.

- **Standard Customs Hold:** Customs agencies legally have up to 30 days to process a package. ShopSphere cannot expedite or interfere with this sovereign process. CSRs must instruct customers to monitor their tracking.
- **Information Request Holds:** If tracking indicates "Customs Clearance Exception - Action Required," the customer must provide their local tax ID or passport number to the final-mile courier. CSRs must provide the customer with the local courier's contact information.

3. Delivery Delays and Scan Failures (International)

International tracking is highly susceptible to shipment scan failures during the "ocean/air transit" phase or the "customs handover" phase. It is perfectly normal for an international tracking number to go 5 to 7 days without an update while crossing borders.

The Lost Package Investigation Procedure (KB-017) cannot be initiated for an international order until 15 consecutive days of scan failures have occurred. Furthermore, standard Late Delivery Escalation Policy (KB-018) compensation matrices do not apply to international orders delayed by customs, as this is outside ShopSphere's control.

4. Address Correction Procedures Limitations

Unlike domestic shipments, international address correction procedures are extremely restricted. Once an international order status updates to "Export Processing," no address changes can be made.

Any attempt to alter the delivery address across national borders or even between local municipalities post-export will result in the package being flagged for fraud by customs and subsequently destroyed. If an international customer inputs the wrong address, the CSR must cancel the order if it has not shipped, or advise the customer that the package cannot be salvaged if it is already in transit. No refunds will be issued for packages destroyed due to customer-provided address errors on international manifests.